

"NO FORCE CAN STOP ME

After her surprise anointment as the UNPA's prime ministerial candidate, BSP supremo Mayawati's confidence levels have reached a new high. She told Editor PRABHU CHAWLA in Seedhi Baat on Aaj Tak that she is destined to become the country's prime minister. Excerpts:

Q. Finally, a Dalit's daughter as a future prime minister?

A. Apart from being a Dalit's daughter, I am also the daughter of India. I have worked not just for Dalits but for all sections of society. I am born in India, so I am not just a Dalit *ki beti*, but also Hindustan *ki beti*.

Q. You said there was a conspiracy against a Dalit's daughter becoming prime minister.

A. They are scared that if BSP forms a government at the Centre and Mayawati becomes the prime minister then they will have to wait for a long time to come back to power at the Centre. That is why they thought it's better not to let me come to power at all.

Q. So they won't let you become the prime minister.

A. If I can become the chief minister of Uttar Pradesh, then I think one day the dreams of our people will surely come true.

Q. Will the dream be realised through Mayawati?

A. Yes, definitely.

Q. Are you sure nothing can stop you now?

A. Yes, a movement has begun. No force can stop me from becoming prime minister if *sarv samaj* votes for me.

Q. What will be your agenda for governance? What are your views on privatisation and economic reforms started by the Manmohan Singh Government?

A. My party is not against privatisation. Like we have done in Uttar Pradesh, at the Centre too we will take care to see that the country's Scheduled Caste people have the benefits of reservations. When a government undertaking is privatised, reservation rights should be protected, as I have done in my state.

Q. Should there be FDI in retail?

A. The interests of the small shopkeepers must be protected.

Q. What about the nuclear deal?

A. Congress claims that due to this deal, we will get cheap electricity. This is wrong. Whatever elec-

tricity we get will be much more expensive and will take 10-15 years to avail it. And we will get only 8-10 per cent more than what we are getting now. It will be so expensive that neither the poor nor the small industrialists can benefit from it.

Q. So will you cancel the deal if a UNPA government headed by you comes to power?

A. When my government comes to power at the Centre, we will surely rethink this deal.

Q. Your opponents claim that your politics is caste-based.

A. Those people who are making such blind



“There are many coalition partners in the UPA and the NDA, who are attracted to the BSP. And there will be a time when they will also join us.”